

Port of Pend Oreille Website Design, Development, and Hosting Services RFP Analysis

1. Executive Summary

What is the client trying to achieve?

The Port of Pend Oreille is seeking professional proposals from qualified vendors to overhaul, modernize, and unify its digital presence. The goal is to create a welcoming, professional, intuitive, and modern online destination that improves public engagement and enhances regional visibility.

What business problem are they solving?

The existing website (povarr.com) is outdated, difficult to navigate, and challenging for internal staff to maintain. Information is fragmented across multiple websites, creating inefficiencies and reducing the effectiveness of public communication.

What is the overall project objective?

To design and implement a single, integrated website platform that:

- Consolidates multiple websites into one unified platform
- Provides an intuitive Content Management Framework (CMF)
- Reduces e-government transaction costs
- Supports multimedia and video content
- Includes secure hosting, monitoring, and maintenance services

2. Client Information

Organization Name

Port of Pend Oreille

Industry / Domain

Municipal Government / Public Port Authority & Logistics

Background Information

The Port of Pend Oreille is a public entity in Washington State that operates short-line freight rail infrastructure and supports regional economic development initiatives. The organization serves both public and commercial stakeholders while maintaining transparency and accessibility.

3. Project Scope

Included Work

Website Design & User Experience

- Custom professional graphic design
- User interface and user experience improvements
- Branding-aligned visual design

Content Migration

- Migration from povarr.com
- Migration from pocedc.com
- Consolidation into a single platform

Content Management System

- User-friendly content management framework
- Role-based permissions
- Self-service content updates by staff

Digital Services

- Online forms
- Electronic submissions
- Interactive maps
- Public transaction workflows

Hosting & Support

- Secure cloud hosting
- 24/7 monitoring
- Ongoing maintenance and support

Expected Deliverables

- Approved design prototypes and wireframes
- Fully migrated centralized website
- Integrated video and multimedia capabilities

- Secure form submission infrastructure
- Staff training and operational documentation

Explicit Exclusions

White-Label Requirement

No web design company branding, signatures, links, badges, or references may appear:

- On the website
- In source code
- In embedded metadata
- In page footers

Vendor branding is strictly prohibited.

4. Functional Requirements

Content Management System (CMS)

The system must allow authorized non-technical staff to:

- Create content
- Edit content
- Publish content
- Delete content
- Upload documents and media

without requiring developer assistance.

Search Functionality

A comprehensive search capability must support:

- Public records
- Board minutes
- Economic reports
- Website content
- Cross-domain indexing

Online Forms and Transactions

Features include:

- Dynamic forms

- Data validation
- Electronic signatures
- File uploads
- Automated routing and notifications

Multimedia Support

The platform must support:

- Native video streaming
- Responsive media playback
- High-performance content delivery

GIS and Mapping

Interactive mapping capabilities must display:

- Port infrastructure
 - Rail routes
 - Industrial zones
 - Economic development areas
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5. Technical Requirements

Architecture

The solution should use modern web technologies that:

- Avoid vendor lock-in
- Support future integrations
- Enable scalability and maintainability

Hosting Requirements

- Secure cloud hosting
- High availability architecture
- Automated daily backups
- 24/7 monitoring
- Disaster recovery capability

Integration Requirements

- Domain management support
- Form processing integrations

- Data export capabilities

Security Requirements

- SSL/TLS encryption
- Role-based access control
- Data encryption at rest
- Web Application Firewall (WAF)
- Secure administration environment

Compliance Requirements

Accessibility

- ADA Section 508 Compliance
- WCAG 2.1 AA Compliance

Regulatory

- State public records requirements
- Federal privacy requirements

6. Timeline & Milestones

Project Timeline

Milestone	Date
Proposal Submission Deadline	September 13, 2024 (1:00 PM PST)
Evaluation & Negotiation	Mid-to-Late September 2024
Contract Award & Kickoff	October 2024
Development & Migration	October–December 2024
Go-Live Deadline	January 1, 2025

Key Observation

The project must be completed within approximately 60–75 days after kickoff, making schedule management critical.

7. Budget & Commercial Information

Budget

No budget amount is specified.

Pricing Expectations

Vendors should provide itemized pricing for:

- Website design
- Development
- Content migration
- Hosting
- Maintenance
- Licensing

Payment Structure

Progress Payments

- Up to 75% of contract value paid through milestone billing

Final Holdback

- 25% retained until final acceptance

Upfront Funding

- No advance payment
- No upfront funding

8. Resource Requirements

Recommended Team Structure

Role	Allocation	Responsibilities
Project Manager	1.0 FTE	Planning, coordination, risk management
Business Analyst	0.5 FTE	Content mapping and requirements
Frontend Developer / UI Designer	1.0 FTE	UX/UI design and accessibility
Backend Developer	1.0 FTE	CMS, forms, integrations

Role	Allocation	Responsibilities
QA Engineer	0.5 FTE	Testing and compliance validation
DevOps Engineer	0.5 FTE	Hosting, deployment, monitoring

9. Risks & Challenges

Technical Risks

- Content migration errors
- Broken links
- Video streaming performance issues
- Search indexing challenges

Timeline Risks

- Extremely compressed implementation schedule
- Limited room for scope changes

Compliance Risks

- Accessibility non-compliance
- Public-sector legal exposure

Financial Risks

- 25% payment holdback
- Cash-flow pressure during execution

10. Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated under RCW 39.04.270 Competitive Negotiations.

Evaluation Factors

Cost Efficiency

- Competitive pricing
- Clear value proposition

Technical Solution

- Architecture quality
- Security
- Accessibility compliance

Relevant Experience

- Municipal website projects
- Public-sector experience

Schedule Realism

- Ability to meet January 1, 2025 deadline
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11. Proposal Submission Requirements

Required Proposal Sections

Corporate Information

- Executive Summary
- Vendor Profile

Technical Solution

- Technical Approach
- Architecture Description
- CMS Strategy
- Form Strategy
- Video Strategy

Migration Plan

- Content migration methodology
- Risk mitigation approach

Cost Proposal

- Detailed itemized pricing
- Hosting and maintenance fees

Experience

- Team resumes
- Municipal project references
- Case studies

Submission Deadline

September 13, 2024 at 1:00 PM PST

12. Information Useful for AI Agents

CEO Agent

Strategic Importance

Government modernization initiative with significant public visibility.

Key Success Factor

Demonstrate confidence in delivering before the fixed January 1, 2025 deadline.

CTO Agent

Architectural Priorities

- White-label solution
- Accessible CMS platform
- Search engine
- Secure forms
- Video delivery platform

Compliance Priorities

- WCAG 2.1 AA
 - ADA Section 508
 - Security best practices
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PM Agent

Major Workstreams

1. UX/UI Design
2. Content Migration
3. Forms Development
4. Video Platform Integration
5. CMS Training
6. Production Launch

Critical Path

Meeting the January 1, 2025 launch date.

CFO Agent

Financial Constraints

- No advance payments
 - 25% retained until completion
 - Cash flow planning required
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HR Agent

Staffing Priorities

- Accessibility specialists
 - Full-stack developers
 - Public-sector project experience
 - Fast deployment capability
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13. Structured Data Summary

Project Metadata

- Project Name: Website Design, Development, and Hosting Services
- Project Number: WEBSITE SERVICES 2024-0924
- Issuing Organization: Port of Pend Oreille
- Submission Deadline: September 13, 2024
- Target Go-Live Date: January 1, 2025
- Procurement Method: RCW 39.04.270 Competitive Negotiations

Legacy Websites

- povarr.com
- pocedc.com

Core Functional Modules

1. Content Management System
2. Enterprise Search
3. Online Forms Engine

4. Multimedia Platform
5. GIS Mapping Module

Mandatory Compliance

- ADA Section 508
- WCAG 2.1 AA
- Public Records Retention Requirements

Key Commercial Requirement

25% of total contract value withheld until final acceptance and project sign-off.